

A GENT JESSICA DREW OF S.H.I.E.L.D. was assigned to escort blind lawyer Matt Murdock and his bodyguard Cage to a maximum security prison to question Sentry, a super hero who believed he had murdered his wife. No sooner did they enter the prison, than a jailbreak occurred, freeing 87 of the world's most dangerous criminals. Captain America, Iron Man, and Spider-Man soon arrived to quell the riot, and a new team of Avengers was born—with new members.

[illegible]

Hero for hire Luke Cage was once framed and sent to prison. In order to obtain early parole, he volunteered to be a test subject for an experimental chemical. An angry guard tried to kill Cage by giving him an overdose. Instead of killing him, the drug reacted with Cage's unique body chemistry and gave him superhuman strength.

Ronin
Once called Echo because of her ability to copy any physical move she saw, Maya Lopez, alias Ronin, is a skilled martial artist and weapons expert. She is also deaf and Daredevil's girlfriend. He recommended her to Captain America.

Located ten blocks from the Fantastic Four's Baxter Building, the Avengers' new headquarters is an office tower owned by Tony Stark.

IT HAD TO BE
When a fate assembles an
unlikely group of heroes,
(Captain America sees it
as a sign to reform
the Avengers.

Saga of Sauron
The jailbreak was arranged by a mutant group called the Savage Land Mutates. Their goal was to free Karl Lykos, who drained energy from his victims to transform into Sauron, a winged reptile with hypnotic powers. The Avengers tracked Lykos to the Savage Land, a jungle inhabited by dinosaurs. There they encountered the X-Man Wolverine, who helped the team defeat the mutants and capture Lykos. The Avengers also uncovered an illegal S.H.I.E.L.D. operation to mine weapons-grade vibranium using slave labor.

Membership of the new team is fluid. Any hero who has ever been an Avenger may be present at meetings, as may luminaries such as Dr. Strange, Reed Richards, Professor Xavier, Black Bolt and Namor.

Wolverine was invited to join the new team with the understanding that he could continue his membership in the X-Men. Logan is a mutant who possesses a healing factor which enables him to recover from almost any injury. It also retards aging. He has superhumanly acute senses and his skeleton has been artificially reinforced with adamantium. His help was crucial when the Avengers were beset by dinosaurs in the Savage Land (*below*).

Wolverine has three natural claws on each hand which have also been sheathed in adamantium. They can cut through almost anything and be triggered or withdrawn in an instant.